A Twist in India's Tryst

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For a long time, I had been struggling to find a sense of purpose in politics. In fact, this quest had been on the back of my mind for long, and I found myself seeking meaning in vain ever since my inadvertent stint with politics began. In fact, the overall politics and discourse at the grassroots appeared blatantly bereft of ideological purpose, forcing me to pause and introspect more often than not. So when I joined the Yatra, although I didn't know what to expect, I had deliberately lowered my expectations. But then I heard something in Kochi, Kerala, which resonated with me, which gave me the path to a truth I had been searching for:

> It is a true honour for me to be able to walk these roads that you walk to go to the offices, to drop your children to schools, to fulfil your daily needs at the markets. When the idea of the Bharat Jodo Yatra was being contemplated, some suggested doing it by car. I said if the Yatra happens by car, I will not be part of it. I will only undertake the Yatra if I can walk the roads that our people walk to travel every day.

Rahul Gandhi spoke these words, which may seem innocuous, but which I found profoundly stirring. Here was a man that could have anything the world could offer, and instead of taking the easy way, was deliberately choosing to take the less-trodden path. This resonated with me because I, too, had consciously decided to give up many things to be in public service. And that deliberate sacrifice for something bigger than ourselves was something that instantly spoke to me.